FaujPrep

Initial Interview 1: A Clear, Natural Self-Introduction

The purpose

A useful introduction helps the interviewer understand who you are and gives the conversation an honest starting point. It is not a speech to memorise word for word. Keep it brief, factual, and easy to follow; the interviewer may interrupt or ask follow-up questions.

A flexible 60- to 90-second structure

1. Identity and background: Give your name, home area, and a concise family or schooling detail if relevant.
2. Education: State your current or completed qualification, subjects, and one genuine point about your academic journey.
3. Interests and responsibility: Mention one or two real activities, roles, skills, or responsibilities. Say what you actually did.
4. Motivation: Explain why you are pursuing a commission and what you understand about the responsibility and demands of service.
5. Close: Finish naturally and allow the interviewer to choose the next topic.

For example, describe an activity as: "I helped organise our school science display. I coordinated the materials with three classmates, and I learned to plan earlier when one item was delayed." A concrete example is stronger than a string of labels such as "confident, brilliant, and born to lead."

A sample introduction to adapt

"I am [name] from [city]. I completed [qualification] with [subjects]. Outside class, I [real activity or responsibility]. In that role, I [specific action], which taught me [lesson]. I am applying for a commission because [your real reason], and I understand that service involves discipline, responsibility, and demands on personal life. I would like to develop further in [relevant area]."

Replace every bracket with a true detail, and omit anything you cannot explain under follow-up. This is a structure, not a script to recite.

Practise the interruption

Candidate: "I helped organise our school science display and coordinated the materials."

Interviewer: "What exactly did you do?"

Candidate: "I made a list of materials, checked who could bring each item, and followed up the day before. One item was late, so we used a safe substitute approved by our teacher."

Interviewer: "What would you do differently?"

Candidate: "I would confirm the critical items earlier and identify a backup in advance. I learned that coordination includes checking progress, not just assigning tasks."

The trick is to answer the new question, add one concrete detail, and stop. Do not restart the entire introduction.

Prepare facts, not a script

Review the details on your application: dates, school names, marks, subjects, activities, and family information. If there is a gap, a change of subject, or a disappointing result, be ready to explain it accurately and briefly. Do not invent awards, responsibilities, or stories. Inconsistencies are avoidable and can undermine trust.

Make a one-page personal fact sheet with:

- Your education timeline and subjects.
- Two genuine strengths, each supported by an example.
- One area you are improving and the steps you are taking.
- A meaningful responsibility or setback and what you learned.
- Your reason for applying, expressed in your own words.

Practise without sounding rehearsed

Record a practice answer once. Check whether it is understandable, relevant, and under 90 seconds. Then practise answering the same question in different words. Ask a family member to interrupt with follow-ups such as "What did you learn?" or "What would you do differently?" Answer the question asked instead of restarting your prepared speech.

In the room

Greet politely, listen to the full question, and answer directly. If you do not know a fact, say so calmly rather than guessing confidently. If you need a moment, take one. Good eye contact means attentive and natural, not staring. Respectful disagreement is better than pretending to agree with every assumption.

Reminder

An introduction cannot secure selection. The goal is honest communication and a fair opportunity for the interviewer to understand your actual background.

Research basis

The ISSB candidate guidelines (https://issb.gov.pk/guidelines) advise candidates to be honest, straightforward, and frank, and caution against false projection. They do not publish a fixed PMA Long Course 160 initial-interview script or question list.